

OREGON'S 1ST CONGRESSIONAL
DISTRICT

Fourteen Years in Washington.

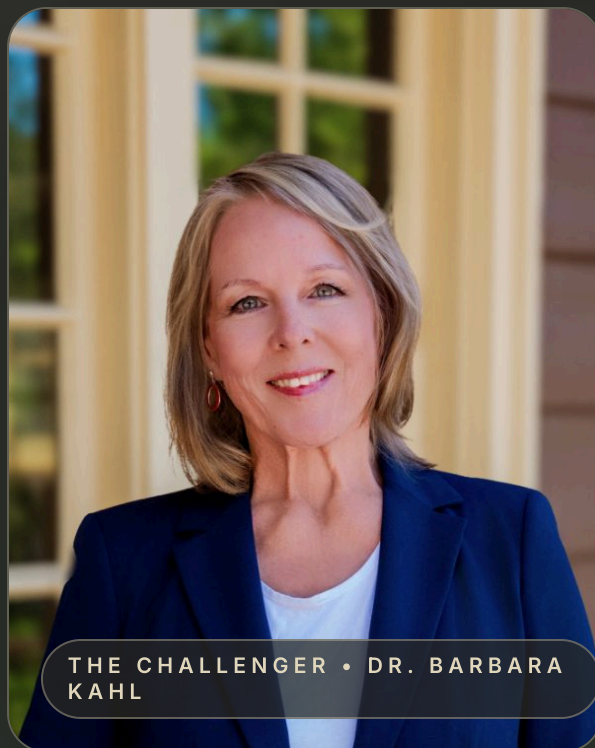
One New Challenger.
Compare the Record.

Barbara Kahl vs. Suzanne Bonamici

ECONOMY • ENERGY • FENTANYL •
SCHOOLS • FORESTRY • FEDERAL
ACCOUNTABILITY

GENERAL ELECTION — November 3, 2026

BEAVERTON • HILLSBORO • WEST
PORTLAND • FOREST GROVE • ASTORIA •
TILLAMOOK • ST. HELENS



THE CHALLENGER • DR. BARBARA
KAHL

FOURTEEN YEARS CREATES A RECORD. COMPARE IT.

PRESENTED BY NORTHWEST OREGON PAC

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THE CANDIDATES

14 Years Creates a Record.

BARBARA KAHL

Veterinarian • Former Intel Employee • Fourth-Generation Oregonian

Barbara Kahl is a fourth-generation Oregonian who graduated from Hillsboro High School and earned degrees in animal science and chemistry before becoming a veterinarian.^[1]

She has spent nearly 20 years operating a mobile veterinary practice across the district and previously worked at Intel.^[1]

In 2022, Kahl was recruited to serve as chief veterinarian for American Samoa, where she helped establish the territory's first animal-control unit and drafted its Veterinary Practice Act.^[1]

HER STATED PRIORITIES

- Economic growth
- Academics and skilled trades
- Addressing fentanyl and strengthening mental-health networks
- Responsible timber harvesting
- Strong ports
- Lower healthcare costs
- Federal accountability
- Identifying fraud and returning savings to taxpayers
- Term limits^[1]

SUZANNE BONAMICI

Member of Congress Since 2012

Suzanne Bonamici entered Congress through a 2012 special election and serves on the House Education and Workforce Committee and House Science, Space and Technology Committee.

HER RECENT POLITICAL AND CONGRESSIONAL RECORD

- Federal education policy emphasizing STEAM, including arts education
- HALT Fentanyl Act Nay vote
- Greater federal education funding^[3]
- O&C Forestry Plan delay claim
- A Nay Vote on H.R. 9576 National Fraud Enforcement Division^[8]
- A Nay vote on H.Con.Res.9, a 2023 resolution "denouncing the horrors of socialism"
- Climate-focused policy^[3]
- A Nay Vote on Fix Our Forests Act
- Water-power and energy research legislation^[4]
- 2026 Oregon Working Families Party endorsement/cross-nomination^[2]

THE QUESTION IS NOT WHETHER SHE HAS EXPERIENCE

It's what that record shows after fourteen years.

CD-1 Makes Things.

Semiconductors in Washington County. Freight through the Columbia. Timber from Northwest Oregon. Tourism and fishing on the coast. Small businesses throughout the district.

Federal decisions on permitting, energy, land use, workforce policy, and regulation can affect the businesses operating here.

BARBARA KAHL

Barbara Kahl's economic argument starts with production.

HER STATED PRIORITIES INCLUDE

- Timber supply.
- Strong Columbia and coastal ports.
- Less red tape on small businesses.
- Workforce investment connected to real jobs.
- Lower regulatory costs for builders and employers.^[1]

Her experience includes both Intel and navigating federal and state veterinary regulation.^[1]

Make it easier to build, grow, ship and hire.

SUZANNE BONAMICI

Bonamici's economic agenda emphasizes STEAM education, expanded federal government investment, climate-related infrastructure and other federal programs.^[3]

She has spent fourteen years representing a district containing one of Oregon's most important manufacturing and technology corridors.^[2]

After 14 years, her record is everywhere to analyse where she stands.

CD-1 Needs Power.

Who Pays for the Next Megawatt?

Homes need electricity. Intel and other manufacturers need reliable electricity. And rapidly expanding data centers and AI infrastructure can create significant additional electricity demand.

SUZANNE BONAMICI

In January 2026, Bonamici introduced H.R. 7129, the Water Power Research and Development Reauthorization Act, with Rep. Nick Begich.^[4]

The legislation addresses hydropower, marine energy and pumped-storage research, including integration with large electrical loads such as data centers.^[4]

HER 2025 VOTING RECORD ALSO INCLUDES NAY VOTES ON

- H.R. 3632 — Power Plant Reliability
- H.R. 3628 — State Planning for Reliability and Affordability
- H.R. 1949 — Unlocking Domestic LNG
- H.R. 1047 — GRID Power
- H.R. 3015 — National Coal Council^[5]

BARBARA KAHL

Kahl argues that large-scale data-center demand should not leave households and manufacturers carrying disproportionate grid costs.

She has called for greater scrutiny of where regional energy is routed and how large-load growth affects existing users.^[1]

HER POINT IS "AUDIT FIRST"

- Where is the power going?
- Who is creating the new demand?
- Who is paying for the infrastructure?

THE TAKEAWAY

The energy record clearly needs a closer look.

How Should the Federal Government Respond?

Fentanyl policy involves questions of enforcement, drug scheduling, treatment, prevention, and mental-health services.

BARBARA KAHL

KAHL'S STATED APPROACH EMPHASIZES

- Keeping fentanyl off Oregon streets
- Mental-health networks
- Community safety
- Treatment and prevention

Keep fentanyl off the streets.
Strengthen mental-health
networks.

SUZANNE BONAMICI

Bonamici's congressional record includes a Nay vote on H.R. 27, the HALT Fentanyl Act, on February 6, 2025.

The legislation addressed the scheduling of fentanyl-related substances under the Controlled Substances Act.

The House passed H.R. 27 by **312–108**. Bonamici was among the members voting Nay.^[8]

TWO APPROACHES TO FEDERAL FENTANYL POLICY

Voters can examine the legislation, the vote, and each candidate's proposed approach.

Education: Academics, Arts and Skilled Trades.

BARBARA KAHL

KAHL SUPPORTS

- Academics
- Phonics
- Teacher freedom
- Vocational and skilled-trade pathways
- School choice
- Funding that follows the student^[1]

Her education position emphasizes academic fundamentals while creating pathways for students pursuing college, vocational education, and skilled trades.

SUZANNE BONAMICI

Bonamici serves on the House Education and Workforce Committee and is Ranking Member of its Early Childhood, Elementary, and Secondary Education Subcommittee.

Her education agenda emphasizes greater federal education investment and STEAM education, integrating the arts with science, technology, engineering, and mathematics.

THE POLICY QUESTIONS

- What should the federal government's role in education be?
- How should schools balance academics, arts, college preparation, and skilled trades?
- Should federal funding expand, or should more education funding follow students and families?
- What measurable outcomes should accompany additional government spending?

Two different approaches to education and workforce preparation.

Healthcare: Who Deals With the Price?

Barbara Kahl is a veterinarian and has spent nearly two decades operating a clinical practice.^[1] Her healthcare argument starts with a basic problem:

Expanding coverage does not automatically make the underlying care less expensive.

BARBARA KAHL

KAHL EMPHASIZES

- Hospital costs
- Drug prices
- Keeping independent practices viable
- Examining costs before creating new taxes
- Scrutinizing the financing behind government healthcare proposals^[1]

Fix the price before moving the bill.

SUZANNE BONAMICI

Bonamici frames healthcare as a moral and access issue and supports a larger public role in healthcare coverage.^[3]

Her campaign has argued against increasing healthcare costs to finance tax reductions for wealthy Americans.^[3]

Coverage and cost are not the same question.

THE QUESTION VOTERS CAN EXAMINE

CD-1 voters can examine which problem each candidate proposes to address first.

FORESTRY

Oregon Forests: Harvest, Management & Federal Policy.

Forestry remains economically and environmentally significant across Northwest Oregon.

BARBARA KAHL

KAHL SUPPORTS

- Responsible timber harvesting
- Maintaining timber supply
- Working forests
- Forest management
- Supporting Oregon timber communities

Harvest timber responsibly.

SUZANNE BONAMICI

Bonamici voted Nay on H.R. 471, the Fix Our Forests Act, on January 23, 2025.

The House passed the legislation **279-141**, with Bonamici among the 141 members voting Nay.

THE COMPARISON

Kahl: Responsible timber harvesting + working forests

Bonamici: Nay on the Fix Our Forests Act + O&C Forestry Plan delay

Forest policy has consequences for timber, jobs and communities.

SIDE - BY - SIDE

The Difference Is Very Clear.

ISSUE	BARBARA KAHL	SUZANNE BONAMICI
Education	Academics + skilled trades + school choice	Federal education investment + STEAM
Fentanyl	Keep fentanyl off streets + mental-health networks	Voted Nay on H.R. 27, HALT Fentanyl Act
Forestry	Harvest timber responsibly	Voted Nay on Fix Our Forests Act + Voted on O&C plan delay
Fraud & Accountability	Claw back fraud + return savings to taxpayers	H.R. 9576 National Fraud Enforcement Division vote: Nay
Economy	Production + ports + timber + fewer regulatory barriers	Federal government investment + climate-related infrastructure
Energy	Reliability + audits + cost allocation	Federal energy research + climate-focused policy
Healthcare	Lower underlying prices	Greater federal government role in coverage
Federal Role	Less regulation + accountability	Broader federal government programs/investment

Fourteen Years Makes the Comparison Possible.

Kahl does not have a congressional voting record.

Bonamici does.

That gives voters a record of legislation, votes, statements, and policy positions to compare with Kahl's stated priorities.

THE CHOICE

Fourteen Years Is Long Enough to Have a Record.

BARBARA KAHL

- Veterinarian
- Former Intel employee
- Fourth-generation Oregonian
- Former chief veterinarian for American Samoa

HER PRIORITIES INCLUDE

1. Academics and skilled trades
2. Keeping fentanyl off the streets and strengthening mental-health networks
3. Responsible timber harvesting
4. Fraud prevention and returning savings to taxpayers
5. Production and ports
6. Reliable energy
7. Healthcare affordability
8. Federal accountability^[1]

SUZANNE BONAMICI

- Member of Congress since 2012
- House Education and Workforce Committee member

HER RECORD INCLUDES

1. Federal education investment and STEAM priorities
2. Nay on H.R. 27, the HALT Fentanyl Act
3. Nay on H.R. 471, the Fix Our Forests Act
4. O&C Forestry Plan delay
5. Climate and federal energy initiatives
6. Working Families Party's 2026 CD-1 endorsement/cross-nomination
7. Progressive voting record^{[2][3][4][5]}

THEN DECIDE

Read it. Compare it. Decide which approach aligns with your priorities.

Learn more about Barbara Kahl at drkahlforcongress.com.

SOURCES & REFERENCES

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7. **Rep. Suzanne Bonamici congressional office** — January 21, 2026 statement.
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9. **U.S. House of Representatives, Office of the Clerk** — H.R. 27, HALT Fentanyl Act, Roll Call 33, February 6, 2025. <https://clerk.house.gov/Votes/202533>
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INFORMATION & SOURCES DISCLAIMER

Candidate positions, statements, voting records, policy information, and other factual claims in this guide are based on publicly available information and cited sources reviewed as of **September 29, 2026**.

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